Carnet Trifold Patterns V2

Same trifold as before — three elastics, a flap that folds in over the stack, closure anchored on the spine. Rebuilt around double-row eyelet clusters and 2.5 mm hardware, in three sizes.

A5 — FLAT PIECE **438 × 212** mm · 3 tiles on US Letter	REGULAR — FLAT PIECE **325 × 216** mm · 2 tiles on US Letter	A6 — FLAT PIECE **312 × 157** mm · 2 tiles, or 1 Legal sheet
HOLES PER COVER **12 + 1** 2.5 mm elastic · 3 mm closure	SPINE, ALL THREE **24 mm** set by the eyelet flange	

01

WHAT CHANGED

Six holes became twelve, and the spacing follows the hardware

V1 put a single row of three 3 mm holes at each end of the spine, on 6 mm centres. That leaves 3 mm of bare leather between hole edges, which is fine for bare holes and *not* fine once a set eyelet puts a flange around each one. A 3 mm eyelet's flange runs about 6.5 mm across; on 6 mm centres the flanges physically cannot sit side by side. That's the bulk and overlap you hit.

So V2 sizes the spine off the **flange**, not the hole. Your 2.5 mm eyelets flange out to roughly 5.5 mm, columns go onto 7 mm centres, and the second row sits 7 mm inboard of the first. That leaves 1.5 mm of clear leather between every pair of neighbouring flanges, in both directions.

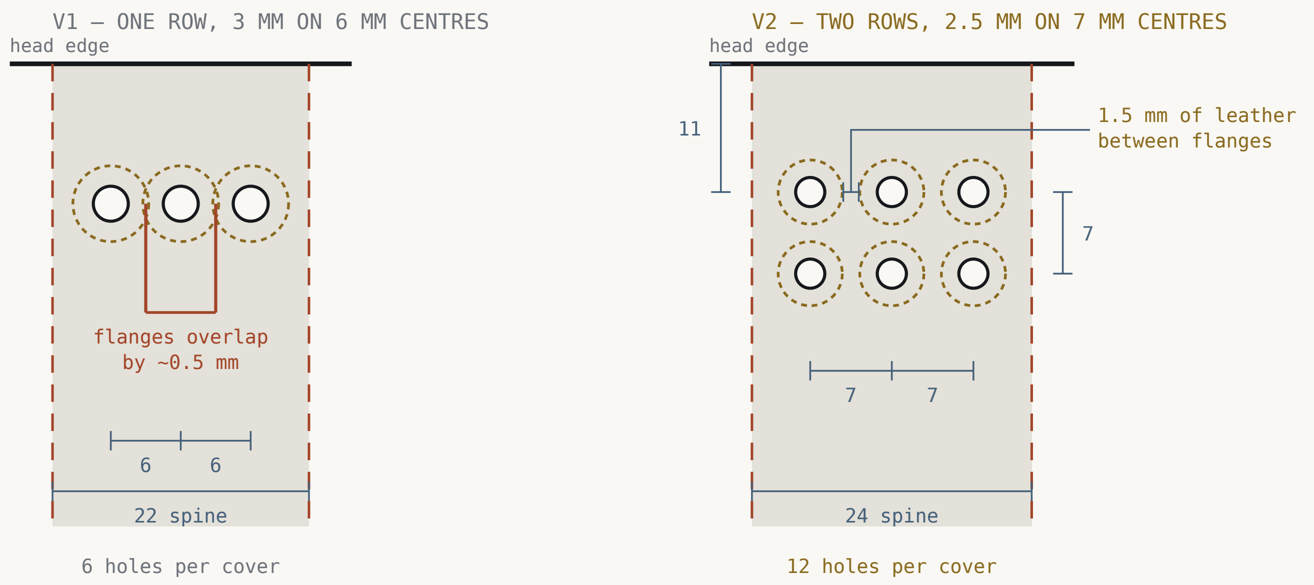

FIG. 01 | SPINE CLUSTER — V1 VS V2 | SHOWN 6× | DASHED RING = SET EYELET FLANGE

Both drawn at the same 6× magnification, top of the spine, outside face up. The dashed rings are the flange each set eyelet leaves on the leather — the thing that actually collides. The holes themselves were never the problem.

DETAIL	V1	V2	WHY
Elastic holes	~~6 — one row of 3 per end~~	12 — two rows of 3 per end	you asked for the double row
Elastic hole dia	~~3.0 mm~~	2.5 mm	to take your 2.5 mm eyelets
Closure hole dia	~~4.0 mm~~	3.0 mm	you asked for a 3 mm eyelet here
Column centres	~~6.0 / 5.5 mm~~	7.0 mm, all three	clears the 5.5 mm flange
Row centres	~~—~~	7.0 mm	new — same clearance vertically
Spine width	~~22 / 20 mm~~	24 mm, all three	consequence of the 7 mm columns
Sizes in the lineup	~~A5 + passport~~	A5 + Regular + A6	Regular is new, A6 is now a true A6
Print tiling	~~Letter landscape, seams both ways~~	Letter portrait, vertical seams only	one line of tape per joint

TWO THINGS I CHANGED ON MY OWN JUDGEMENT

The elastic holes are 2.5 mm, not the 2 mm you asked for. A 2.5 mm eyelet barrel will not pass through a 2.0 mm hole. If your eyelets turn out to want a snug undersized pilot, that's one number in the build script.

All three spines are 24 mm. Three columns of 5.5 mm flanges need that width whatever size the book is — the hardware doesn't shrink with the paper. Making them identical means one punch layout, one setting jig, one set of numbers. It does leave the A6 with a spine that's chunky for its size; the only real ways to slim it are smaller eyelets or two elastics instead of three, and section 11 has both sets of numbers.

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02 THE DOUBLE ROW

What the second row is actually for

With one row, each elastic pulls straight against the edge of a single hole. Over time that edge stretches and the hole goes oval, and the elastic leaves the spine at whatever angle the insert drags it to.

With two rows, the elastic exits the **inner** hole, crosses a 7 mm bar of leather on the outside, and re-enters through the **outer** hole, where it terminates in a stopper knot on the inside. The load is carried by that bar — spread across two eyelets and the leather between them — rather than by one hole edge. It also means the strand leaves the spine parallel to it, so the inserts hang square.

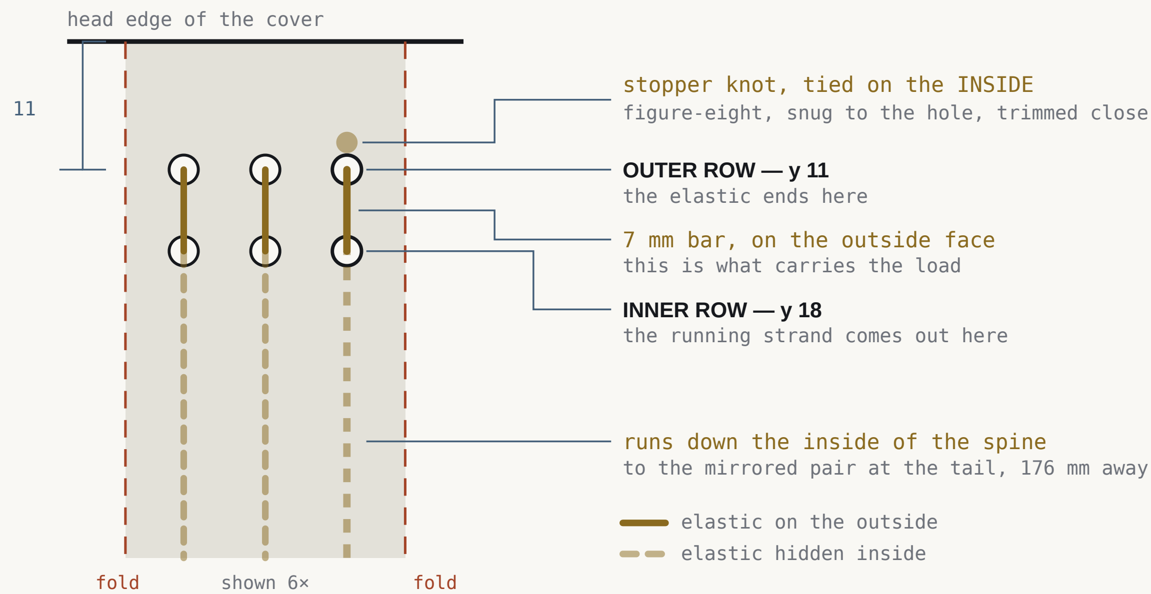

FIG. 02 | ELASTIC ANCHORING AT THE DOUBLE ROW | OUTSIDE FACE UP

A5 DIMENSIONS — A6 IDENTICAL BAR 7 MM

One elastic per column, three columns, three inserts. The tail of the cover is the mirror of this about the cover's horizontal centreline, so each elastic is anchored the same way at both ends.

> THE KNOT LANDS UNDER THE INSERT
>
> At y = 11 the stopper knot sits about 6 mm inside the head of the cover, which is under the top edge of the insert stack. That's true of any traveler's cover and it's fine at 2 mm elastic — but trim the tails close, and set that outer eyelet with the rolled side facing in so the knot is bearing on smooth brass rather than a cut edge.

03

THE FLAT PATTERN

All three, drawn to the same scale

Outside face up, reading `FRONT · SPINE · BACK · FLAP`. The flap hangs off the **back** cover's fore-edge so it folds in over the insert stack and the front cover closes on top of it.

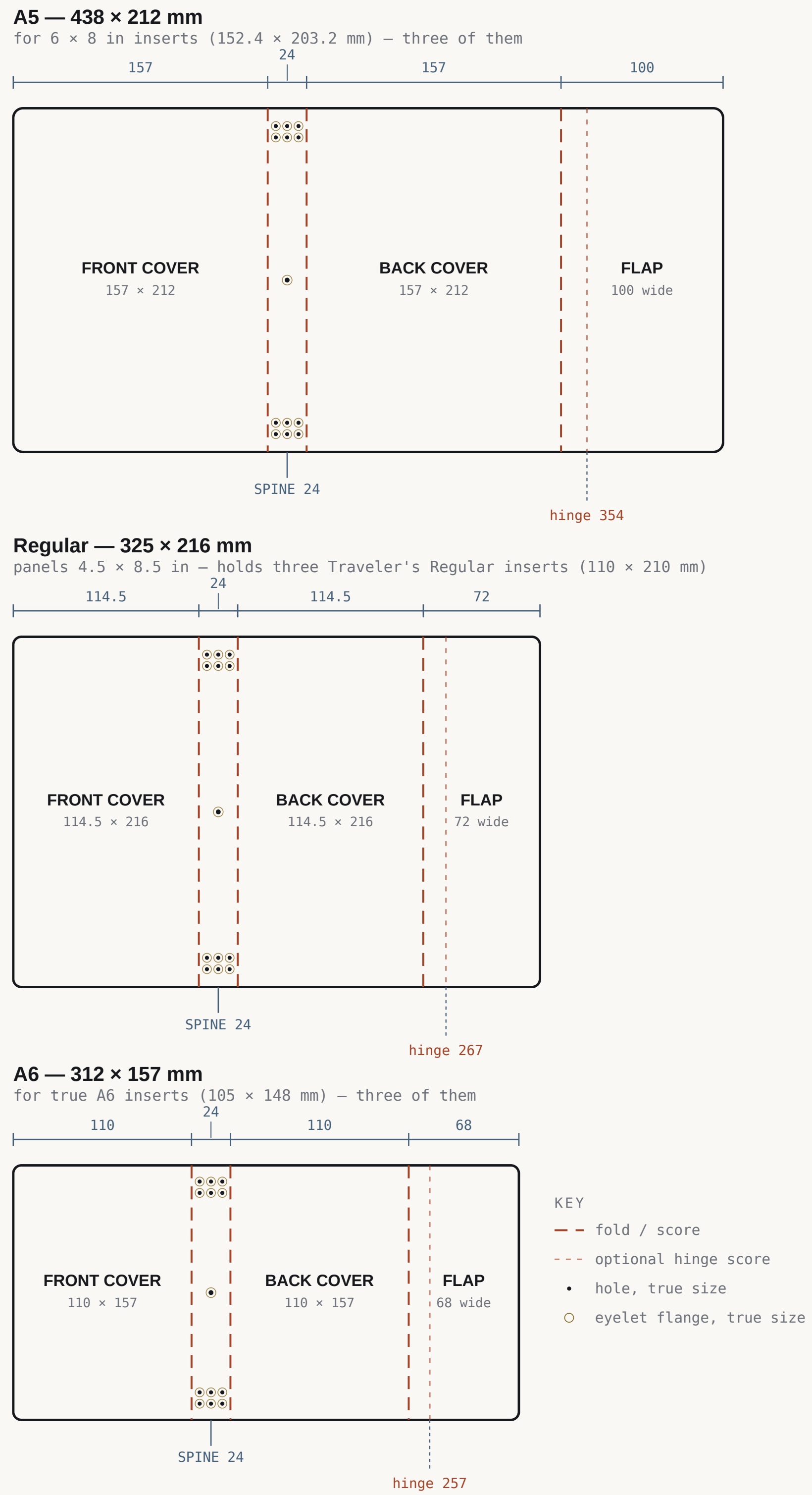

FIG. 03 | FLAT CUTTING PATTERNS | 1 PX = 1 MM — ALL THREE AT THE SAME SCALE | OUTSIDE FACE UP

Holes and flanges are drawn at true size relative to the piece, which is why each cluster reads as one small block rather than six separate dots. The spine is the same 24 mm on all three — it holds the same hardware regardless of how big the book is, which is most obvious on the A6.

DIMENSION	A5	REGULAR	A6	NOTE
Insert it fits	152.4 × 203.2	110 × 210	105 × 148	three of them
Cover panel	157 × 212	114.5 × 216	110 × 157	overhang varies, see below
Fore-edge overhang	4.6	4.5	5	beyond the insert
Head / tail overhang	4.4	3	4.5	each end
Spine width	24	24	24	set by the eyelet flange
Flap width	100	72	68	measured from the fold
Flat piece	438 × 212	325 × 216	312 × 157	the cut outline
Leather needed	450 × 224	337 × 228	324 × 169	minimum, with handling margin
Corner radius	6	5	5	all four outer corners
Fold lines at x =	157 / 181 / 338	114.5 / 138.5 / 253	110 / 134 / 244	from the left edge
Optional hinge score	354	267	257	helps the flap climb the stack

All values in millimetres, measured from the top-left corner of the flat piece, outside face up.

04

HOLE SCHEDULE

Thirteen holes, two diameters

HOLE	A5 X	A5 Y	REG X	REG Y	A6 X	A6 Y	DIA
Head, outer row — 1	162	11	119.5	11	115	10	2.5
Head, outer row — 2	169	11	126.5	11	122	10	2.5
Head, outer row — 3	176	11	133.5	11	129	10	2.5
Head, inner row — 1	162	18	119.5	18	115	17	2.5
Head, inner row — 2	169	18	126.5	18	122	17	2.5
Head, inner row — 3	176	18	133.5	18	129	17	2.5
Closure	169	106	126.5	108	122	78.5	3

HOLE	A5 X	A5 Y	REG X	REG Y	A6 X	A6 Y	DIA
Tail, inner row — 1	162	194	119.5	198	115	140	2.5
Tail, inner row — 2	169	194	126.5	198	122	140	2.5
Tail, inner row — 3	176	194	133.5	198	129	140	2.5
Tail, outer row — 1	162	201	119.5	205	115	147	2.5
Tail, outer row — 2	169	201	126.5	205	122	147	2.5
Tail, outer row — 3	176	201	133.5	205	129	147	2.5

Millimetres from the top-left corner of the flat piece, outside face up. Per cover you need 12 × 2.5 mm eyelets and 1 × 3 mm.

MEASURE A SET EYELET BEFORE YOU CUT THE REAL PIECE

Every spacing number above assumes a set 2.5 mm eyelet flanges out to **5.5 mm**. Some run to 6 mm, and a few of the cheaper brass ones splay wider than that when you set them. Page 2 of each PDF has a true-size 5.5 mm ring to drop one of yours onto. If it overhangs, raise `FLANGE_D` in the script and re-run before cutting leather — the columns, rows and spine all move together.

05 HOW IT FOLDS

The flap belongs to the back cover

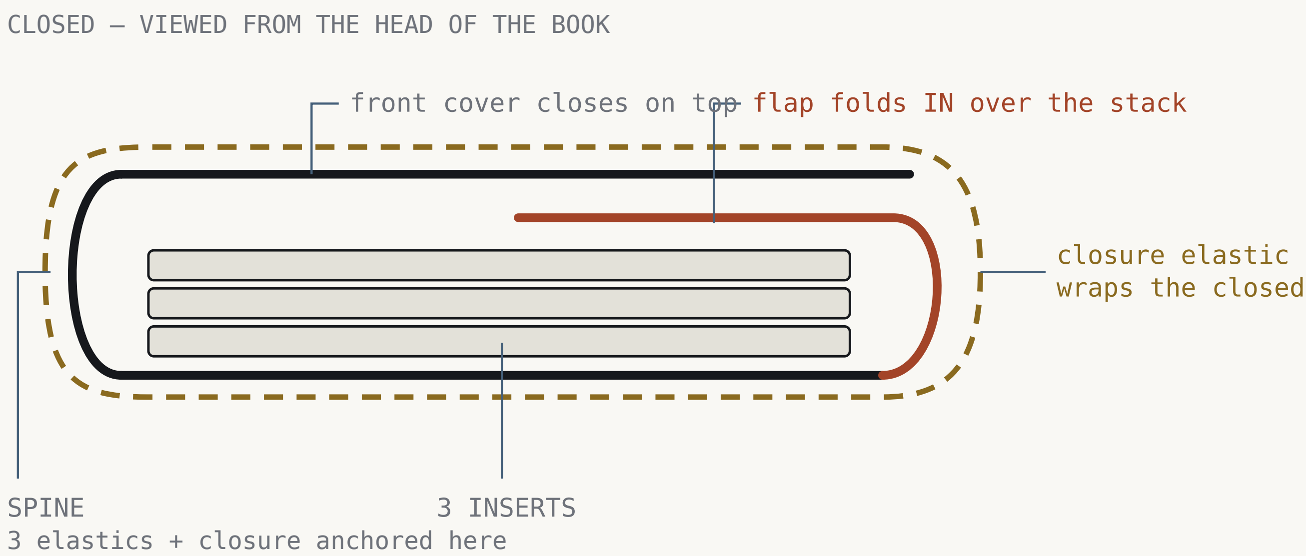

FIG. 04	CLOSED COVER, CROSS-SECTION	SCHEMATIC — NOT TO SCALE	A5 SHOWN

The flap has to climb the stack, so it loses roughly one stack-thickness of reach. A 100 mm A5 flap covers about 85 mm of the page once it lies flat; the 72 mm A6 flap covers about 60 mm.

06 FILES

What to open for which job

`a5-cover-v2-mirrored.svg`	**Start here for the Maker.** Cricut's guidance for genuine leather is face down on the mat, which mirrors the cut — so the mirrored file is the one you want. 438 × 212 mm.
`regular-cover-v2-mirrored.svg`	The 4.5 × 8.5 in cover, mirrored. 325 × 216 mm.
`a6-cover-v2-mirrored.svg`	True A6, mirrored. 312 × 157 mm.
`…-cover-v2.svg`	The same three patterns un-mirrored, for cutting grain side up or for opening in another program.
`a5-cover-v2-letter.pdf`	5 pages — instructions, scale check, then 3 full-size tiles.

`regular-cover-v2-letter.pdf`	4 pages — instructions, scale check, then 2 tiles.
`a6-cover-v2-letter.pdf`	4 pages — instructions, scale check, then 2 tiles.
`a6-cover-v2-legal.pdf`	**The A6 with no tiling at all.** 3 pages of US Legal — instructions, scale check, and the whole template on one sheet turned 90°. This is the one size in the lineup that fits.
`build_templates_v2.py`	Generates all ten. Every dimension is in the three `Cover(...)` blocks at the top; edit and re-run to rebuild everything at once.

Every SVG has two layers

`CUT` holds the outline and the thirteen holes. `FOLD` holds four vertical score lines. Set `FOLD` to **Pen / Draw**, or delete it. Left as Cut it will slice your cover into four strips.

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07 PRINTING

Three pages, one line of tape per joint

The A5 and Regular pieces don't fit any single US sheet — at 212 mm and 216 mm tall they're taller than the short side of Letter or Legal once you allow for printer margins. But both clear a *portrait* Letter page's height, which is the useful trick: tile across the width only, so every seam runs vertically, there's one straight tape line per joint, and nothing has to be aligned in two directions at once.

The A6 is the exception. At 312 × 157 mm it fits a single US Legal sheet turned 90°, with about 29 mm of margin along the long edges and 13 mm at the foot. That's what `a6-cover-v2-legal.pdf` is — no seams, no tape, no registration to get wrong. If you're cutting the A6 by hand, print that one and skip the tiling entirely.

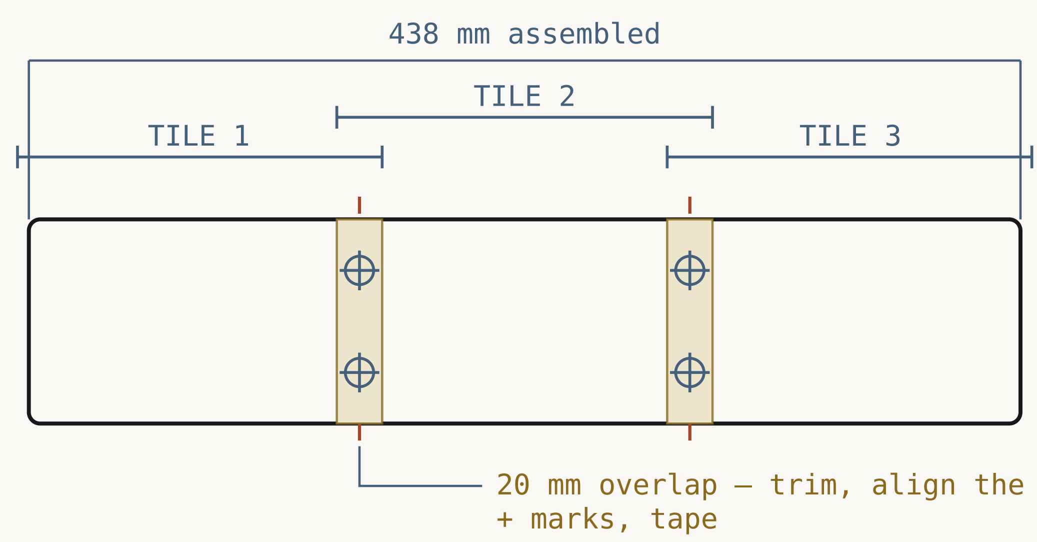

FIG. 05	TILE MAP — A5	3 × US LETTER PORTRAIT	REGULAR AND A6 USE 2 TILES

Each seam carries two registration crosses, one near the head and one near the tail. Get both onto their partners and the joint is square — a single cross lets the page pivot.

01 Print at 100%, then prove it

Turn off "fit to page" and "scale to paper size". Page 2 of each PDF has a 100 mm bar and a 6 inch bar — measure one before you cut anything. If they're short, reprint; don't compensate by cutting bigger.

02 Trim, overlay, tape

Trim each tile along its `TRIM / TAPE LINE`, lay it over the next so the crosses coincide, and tape the overlap. Work left to right, then check the assembled length against the flat-piece dimension printed across the head of the template.

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08 ON THE MAKER

Cut the outline on the machine, punch the holes by hand

> THESE ARE STARTING SETTINGS, NOT TESTED NUMBERS
>
> I can't test-cut from here, and I don't know your hide. Run the pattern on an offcut — or just a corner and a few holes — before you commit a full-size piece of hide.

One honest warning about the holes: 2.5 mm circles are near the bottom of what a rotary or deep-point blade cuts cleanly in leather. The blade has to pivot inside a 1.25 mm radius, and what usually comes out is a slightly torn hole or a plug that won't release. A hand punch gives a rounder hole that seats an eyelet better.

So my recommendation is to let the Maker cut the outline and the corner radii — the part that's genuinely tedious by hand — and either delete the holes from the CUT layer, or leave them and treat whatever it produces as a pilot to open up with a 2.5 mm punch. Try both on a scrap.

01 Check the size on import

Confirm Design Space reports the right size before anything else — SVG import scaling is the most common way a template silently comes out wrong. It should read `438 × 212 mm` (17.24 × 8.35 in) for the A5, `325 × 216 mm` (12.80 × 8.50 in) for the Regular, or `312 × 157 mm` (12.28 × 6.18 in) for the A6. If it's off, set the width explicitly.

02 Deal with the FOLD layer first

Set it to Pen/Draw or delete it, before you do anything else. This is the mistake that costs you a whole piece of leather.

03 Mat and material

StrongGrip (purple) 12 × 24 mat, with the piece rotated 90° — all three patterns clear the 11.5 × 23.5 in cutting area that way, and none of them fits a 12 × 12. Leather grain side down, brayered flat, all four edges taped so nothing creeps mid-cut.

04 Blade and passes

Deep Point blade for 2–3 oz genuine leather. Closest genuine-leather preset, Fast Mode off, expect two passes. Check the cut *before* unloading the mat — *Cut again* is only available while the mat is still in.

05 Release it carefully

Peel the mat away from the leather, not the leather off the mat, or the piece curls. Clear any hole plugs with an awl.

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09 BY HAND

Punching and setting

01 Mark through the paper

Lay the assembled template outside face up on the grain side. Mark the corners and the four fold lines with a scratch awl and prick all thirteen hole centres through the paper. Each hole on the template has a centre cross so you can land the point precisely.

02 Cut the outline

Straight edges against a steel rule with a fresh blade — one confident pass, not several timid ones. For the corners, a radius punch (6 mm for the A5, 5 mm for the Regular and A6) beats freehand every time.

03 **Punch all thirteen while the piece is flat**

2.5 mm for the twelve elastic holes, 3 mm for the closure. Punch into end grain or a poly board. Do this *before* creasing — a folded panel won't sit flat under a punch, and the spine is exactly where all the holes are.

04 **Set the eyelets from the outside**

Flange on the outside of the spine, rolled side inside where the inserts run. Work from the middle of each cluster outward and check the spine stays flat as you go — twelve eyelets in a 24 mm band will bow the leather if you over-set them. Under-set is recoverable; over-set splits the barrel.

05 **Crease the folds**

Dampen the grain slightly, run a bone folder along a straight edge on each of the three solid fold lines, and fold away from the grain side. At 2–3 oz you don't need to skive or groove.

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10 ASSEMBLY

Closure first, then the elastics

The order matters. The middle elastic runs straight down the inside of the spine over the closure hole, so if you fit the elastics first you'll be fighting them to seat the closure knot.

01 **Closure elastic**

Fold the closure length in half and push the folded end through the 3 mm spine eyelet from the *inside* out. Pass both tails through the loop that emerges and pull it snug — a lark's head sitting flat against the outside of the spine. Knot the tails into a loop sized to wrap the closed book under light tension, then trim.

02 **Middle elastic — head end first**

From the inside, push one end out through the **inner** hole of the head cluster's middle column, across the 7 mm bar, and back in through the **outer** hole. Tie a figure-eight stopper on the inside, snug against the outer eyelet, and trim the tail short.

03 **Same elastic — tail end**

Run the working end down the inside of the spine, over the closure knot, and repeat at the tail cluster: out the inner hole, across the bar, in the outer hole, figure-eight on the inside. Set the tension before you knot — the strand should be just taut with the cover flat, not stretched.

04 **Outer two elastics**

Same method, same tension, one column at a time. Light tension only — an elastic should hold an insert without pulling the spine into an hourglass.

05 **Load the inserts and check the flap**

Slide each insert's centrefold under its strand. Close the book, fold the flap in over the stack, then close the front cover on top. If the flap fights the stack, add the optional hinge score and re-crease.

ELASTIC	A5	REGULAR	A6	NOTE
Insert elastics (×3)	`300 mm each`	`300 mm each`	`240 mm each`	generous; trim after both knots
Closure	`400 mm`	`320 mm`	`300 mm`	size the loop to the loaded book
Total per cover	`~1.3 m`	`~1.2 m`	`~1.0 m`	2 mm round elastic

2 mm elastic through a 2.5 mm eyelet is a working fit — snug enough not to rattle, loose enough to thread without a needle.

11 TUNING

If your hardware or leather differs

Your eyelet flange is wider than 5.5 mm

This is the one that matters, and it cascades. The chain is `col_gap = flange + 1.5`, then `spine_w = 2 × col_gap + flange + 2 × 2.25`. A 6 mm flange gives 7.5 mm columns and a 25.5 mm spine; a 6.5 mm flange gives 8 mm and 27 mm. Set `FLANGE_D`, `COL_GAP`, `ROW_GAP` and `SPINE_W` together and re-run — the script checks all three clearances and tells you if any of them fails.

Going narrower — especially on the A6

The floor for the column spacing is the flange plus about 1 mm. Below that the bridges between eyelets start tearing out as you set them, and once one goes there's no repairing it. On a 24 mm spine carrying 5.5 mm flanges there is essentially nothing left to give — tightening to 6.5 mm centres buys you 23 mm, which isn't worth the risk.

If the A6 spine really is too chunky for the book, there are only two honest levers. **Smaller eyelets:** 2 mm hardware flanges to about 4.5 mm, giving 6 mm columns and a 21 mm spine. **Two elastics instead of three:** two columns give `7 + 5.5 + 4.5 = 17 mm`, a properly slim spine — at the cost of one insert. Say which and I'll rebuild it.

Thicker leather

Past about 1.5 mm, add roughly 1 mm of spine per extra 0.5 mm of thickness, and start relieving the fold lines — a creasing groove on the grain side or a shallow skive on the flesh side. The optional hinge score stops being optional. Also check your eyelets' grip range: a barrel sized for 1 mm won't set properly through 2 mm.

Different inserts

Panels run roughly `insert + 4.5 mm` on the fore-edge and `insert + 3 to 4.5 mm` at head and tail — the Regular is tighter than the others because its panel size was copied from a cover you already like rather than derived from its inserts. The spine doesn't move when the paper does; it's set by hardware, unless `3 × (insert thickness) + 6` exceeds 24 mm, which at three ordinary inserts it won't.

Regenerating everything

The three `Cover(...)` blocks near the top of `build_templates_v2.py` hold every number on this page. Change them and re-run; six SVGs and four PDFs rebuild together. It prints the full hole schedule and fails loudly if anything collides — flange to flange, flange to fold, flange to edge, closure to the inner row, panel to insert, tile width against the printable area, and the rotated fit on a Legal sheet. The drawings and tables on this page are generated from those same blocks, so the guide can't drift out of step with the templates.

Panel widths, hole positions and elastic lengths are computed, not measured off an existing cover. The 5.5 mm flange is an assumption about hardware I can't see; the Cricut settings are a sensible starting point rather than tested values.

Cut a test piece before you cut the good leather.